

Chips Lead Again

QCOM +8.42% on hyperscaler data center disclosure.
CRDO +11.52%. Indices grind to fresh records on narrow breadth. **VIX +6.81%**.

THE SESSION

The index ended Monday roughly where it began; the semiconductor sleeve did not. The S&P 500 closed at 7,412.95 (+0.19%), the Dow at 49,704.48 (+0.19%), and the Nasdaq at 26,267.79 (+0.08%) — all marginally green, all near record territory. The Russell 2000 led the major averages at +0.33%. Beneath that placid surface, breadth was narrower than the tape suggested, with more than half of NYSE issues declining. The VIX rose 6.81% to 18.36, a quiet warning that the calm at the index level is being purchased with rising hedging demand.

The day belonged to one stock. Qualcomm gained 8.42% to \$237.53 after CEO Cristiano Amon disclosed that the company's data center processors are on track to ship to a major hyperscaler before the end of calendar 2026. That single line reframed Qualcomm from a handset and licensing business into a credible participant in AI infrastructure. QCOM was the single best performer in both the S&P 500 and the Nasdaq 100. CRDO compounded the move in the same direction, gaining 11.52% to \$210.22 as the optical connectivity layer of the same build-out continued to rerate.

The Morning Brief opened the week with AMD's Q1 print as proof that AI infrastructure demand persists. Today extended the answer: the demand is not concentrated in one name, and the connectivity, networking, and edge-compute layers around the GPUs are now drawing their own bid. The headline indices barely moved because the gains were narrow. The portfolio moved considerably more because the names that ran are exactly the ones it owns.

IOWN Tactical: Concentration in the AI infrastructure complex is the intentional design of the portfolio, not an accident of the rally. Days like today are what that design is for.

IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

CRDO +11.52% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed at \$210.22. AI connectivity rerating continues, with the DustPhotonics integration narrative and the broader optical interconnect bid carrying the name to a fresh leg higher.

QCOM +8.42% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed at \$237.53 after CEO Amon disclosed data center processors will ship to a major hyperscaler before year-end. Touched an intraday \$247.90. Multiple analyst targets raised; Tigress to \$280, Daiwa to \$225.

COIN +7.68% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed at \$216.60 as digital asset infrastructure caught a bid alongside the broader crypto complex. IBIT +2.24% and ETHA +1.03% confirmed the tone.

HOOD +4.84% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed at \$80.76. Retail trading platform participated in the digital asset and risk-on flows; intraday range tight near the day's highs.

FCX +4.41% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed at \$64.37. Copper exposure remains the metal of the AI build-out; the same data center demand driving QCOM and CRDO supports FCX's end-market.

NTR +4.33% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed at \$71.29. Fertilizer and ag inputs caught a bid on broader commodity strength; the move was clean and on volume.

CAT +3.27% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed at \$926.79. Industrial bellwether participated in the modest cyclical tone; data center construction exposure continues to support the multiple.

DECLINERS

SYF -3.91% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed at \$70.28. Consumer credit names underperformed as the financial sector lagged the day's tech-led tape.

GPC -3.15% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed at \$101.42. Auto and industrial parts retailer continued to drift on no specific catalyst; the name remains a defensive holding in a risk-on session.

CHD -2.91% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed at \$90.72. Staples weakness was consistent with rotation away from defensives as the index neared record highs.

TSM -1.73% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed at \$404.54. The foundry gave back some of last week's gains even as its U.S. customers (QCOM, CRDO) led the tape; an idiosyncratic divergence worth watching.

HOLDINGS NEWS

QCOM — Hyperscaler Data Center Deal Confirmed. CEO Cristiano Amon disclosed that Qualcomm's custom data center

processors will ship to a major hyperscaler customer before the end of calendar 2026. The company also raised \$20 billion in new share repurchase authorization on top of \$2.1 billion still unused from prior plans, and raised the quarterly dividend. The next major catalyst is the June 24 Investor Day, where management is expected to outline the scope of the data center opportunity in detail.

CTRA — Delisted Following Devon Merger Close. Coterra Energy completed its all-stock merger with Devon Energy on May 7 and has been delisted from the NYSE. The combined entity carries an estimated \$58 billion enterprise value with projected \$1 billion in annual synergies and a 33% dividend increase. The position will reflect the new Devon Energy shares going forward.

PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY

✓ BEAT BOTH

+0.63%

vs. DVY -0.05% | SPY +0.22%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO

✓ BEAT

+2.14%

vs. IUSG +0.25%

YEAR-TO-DATE

Dividend +12.77% vs DVY +7.84% / SPY +8.41%

Growth +12.51% vs IUSG +10.02%